

Recruiting Freshers



Eighty-five per cent of the IDHs also recruited freshers, paying them between Rs 100,000 and Rs 600,000 per annum.

The industry needs hardware engineers from electrical or electronics stream. Knowledge of embedded systems is also preferable. Those who have done projects in hardware design are naturally one up.

Sinha said, "We do look for their projects, and fundamentals have to be strong." Additionally, they should have a good knowledge of semiconductors, digital signal processing, server languages like Java and Python, and Web development. They should have good analytical skills and logical thinking, and be fast learners.

S. Uma Mahesh, co-founder and CEO, Indrin, added, "Original thinkers and energetic and good team workers are preferred." Attitude and discipline are also essential.

Some companies have tied up with institutes and universities for recruitment. Shankar said, "We have

Key findings

1. Telecom and consumer electronics are the major markets.
2. Majority of customers are from USA or European countries like Germany, Sweden, the UK and France.
3. IDHs face a number of challenges, like acquiring the right talent pool and right customers, to achieve their growth targets.
4. Their strategies for growth include developing new products and exploring new verticals, innovation, fixed-cost model, changing the focus region and long-term partnership with customers.
5. The recession impact was flat for a majority of the IDHs. Thirty per cent recorded growth during the recession.
6. Eighty-five per cent recruit freshers, with salary ranging between Rs 100,000 and Rs 600,000 per annum. They train the freshers for a period ranging between one week and six months.
7. The top three marketing tools are participation in events, one-on-one meetings and word-of-mouth.
8. Strategies to counter competition include offering a single-window or one-stop shop for all the customers' needs, partnering with top silicon companies, working on specific customer needs, being flexible, investing highly in R&D, innovation and building domain expertise.
9. Technology trends include low power consumption, low geometry, integration of multiple functions (power, analogue, intelligence and communication) and green technologies. Other trends include the need to innovate and improve quality, and find the right partners to enable effective and efficient product development; customers' preference for one-stop solutions for designs as well as production; customers looking for more value-addition; shift from time-and-material business model to fixed-price turnkey projects; and more interest in risk-reward models.
10. Lucrative verticals for the next five years are telecom, renewable energy and consumer electronics, followed by automotive, healthcare and aerospace.

tied up with the Manipal Institute of Technology and created a two-year MS programme. Twenty per cent students of that course are hired by us."

Most companies also give the fresh recruits a training that might range from one week to six months. While some do this as a separate exercise, others do it on-the-job. The training

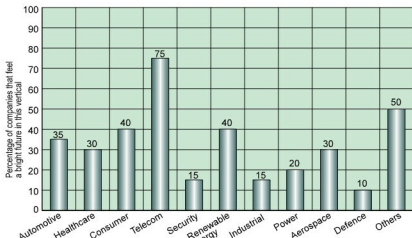
might usually be split into a generic one followed by a detailed vertical-oriented specialisation.

Opportunities abound

The future seems quite bright for IDHs. Majority of the IDHs (75 per cent) saw telecom as the most prospective market, followed by renewable energy and consumer electronics (40 per cent each). Other prospective markets include automotive (35 per cent), healthcare and aerospace (30 per cent each), power (20 per cent), security and industrial electronics (15 per cent) and defence (10 per cent). Some other significant areas are industrial automation, light-emitting diodes, artificial intelligence, IT, home automation and Internet protocol television.

In short, there is a lot to look forward to, and the IDHs have their strategies charted right to mount every challenge and tap every opportunity. ●

Potential Verticals



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